

SafeGuard

fraud/romance-scam detection and SafeLink anonymous trafficking-vict

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The Problem

Romance and investment scams cost victims an estimated \$10+ billion annually worldwide, and an estimated 27.6 million people are in situations of forced labor or trafficking (ILO/Walk Free).

Victims of romance and investment fraud typically have no real-time warning system before money is sent, and trafficking victims often lack a safe, anonymous first step to seek help. SafeGuard is deliberately built as a prevention and victim-support tool, not a private enforcement tool.

How It Works

- ScamShield: NLP pattern-matching engine scores incoming message text against known scam tactics (urgency framing, fake investment returns, gift-card/wire requests).
- ScamShield: perceptual image-hashing cross-references submitted profile photos against a crowdsourced reported-scammer database.
- SafeLink: anonymous, non-attributable tip submission channel, routed directly to NAPTIP, IOM, and the National Human Trafficking Hotline.
- SafeLink: location-based resource locator surfaces the nearest verified shelter or legal aid contact under time pressure.

Core Data Model

- ScamReport — Submitted message/profile pattern, similarity score against known tactics.
- ReportedProfile — Crowdsourced record of a reported scammer photo/profile, cross-referenced across submissions.
- TraffickingTip — Anonymized tip submission, routed to the appropriate hotline/agency.
- ResourceLocator — Verified shelter, legal aid, and NGO support resource by location.

Security, Privacy & Compliance

- SafeLink tips are architecturally anonymous by default — no persistent identifying metadata retained unless the reporter explicitly opts in.
- ScamShield's reported-scammer database is moderated to prevent misuse for harassment; multiple corroborating reports required.
- Explicit scope boundary: no surveillance, no narcotics-network targeting, no vigilante action — strictly prevention, detection, and routing to legitimate authorities.

Market Opportunity & Funder Fit

Global online fraud-prevention software market projected to exceed \$80B by 2030. Target beachhead: consumer scam-pattern detection in Nigeria and UK diaspora corridors.

Strong fit for anti-trafficking and consumer-protection funding: US J/TIP grants, EU Anti-Trafficking Action Grants, UNODC, and Google.org/Meta digital safety grants.

The Ask

\$130,000 grant to launch ScamShield public beta + SafeLink hotline integration, 12 months.

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